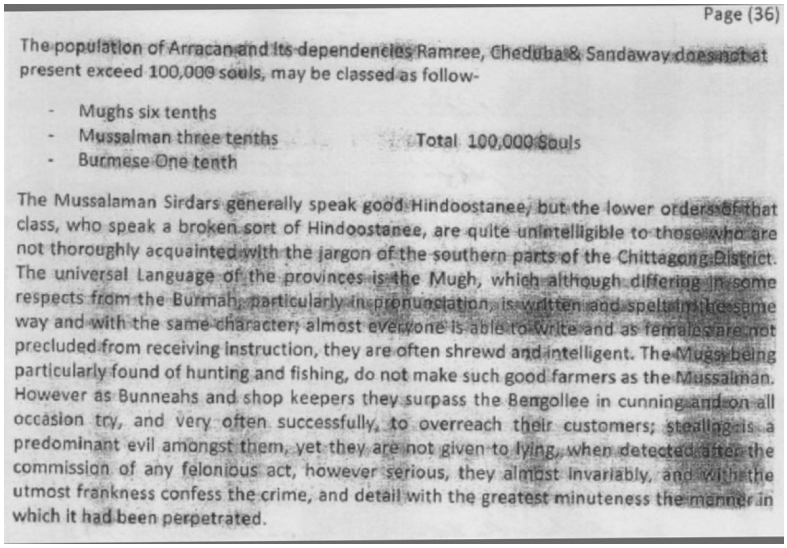
APPENDIX 2

EXCERPT FROM PATON'S REPORT[1]



The population of Arracan and its dependencies Ramree, Cheduba & Sandaway does not at present exceed 100,000 souls, may be classed as follow-

- Mughs six tenths
- Mussalman three tenths — Total 100,000 Souls
- Burmese One tenth

The Mussalaman Sirdars generally speak good Hindoostanee, but the lower orders of that class, who speak a broken sort of Hindoostanee, are quite unintelligible to those who are not thoroughly acquainted with the jargon of the southern parts of the Chittagong District. The universal Language of the provinces is the Mugh, which although differing in some respects from the Burmah, particularly in pronunciation, is written and spelt in the same way and with the same character; almost everyone is able to write and as females are not precluded from receiving instruction, they are often shrewd and intelligent. The Mugs being particularly found of hunting and fishing, do not make such good farmers as the Mussalman. However as Bunneahs and shop keepers they surpass the Bengollee in cunning and on all occasion try, and very often successfully, to overreach their customers; stealing is a predominant evil amongst them, yet they are not given to lying, when detected after the commission of any felonious act, however serious, they almost invariably, and with the utmost frankness confess the crime, and detail with the greatest minuteness the manner in which it had been perpetrated.